

# Patricia & Harold Bennett - Retired couple with estate planning focus

**ID:** retired\_couple **Net Worth Range:** £800k - £900k **Focus:** Inheritance Tax planning, gifting strategy

A retired couple in their early 70s in Tunbridge Wells. Both drawing Defined Benefit pensions from public sector careers (NHS and Civil Service). No debt, substantial savings, and active gifting to grandchildren. Key focus on Inheritance Tax planning.

## User Profile

| Field                    | Value                        |
|--------------------------|------------------------------|
| Name                     | Patricia Bennett             |
| Email                    | patricia.bennett@example.com |
| Date of Birth            | 1955-04-22                   |
| Age                      | 70                           |
| Gender                   | Female                       |
| Marital Status           | Married                      |
| Annual Income            | £0 (retired)                 |
| Employment Status        | Retired                      |
| Former Employer          | NHS                          |
| Occupation               | Retired Nurse Manager        |
| Target Retirement Age    | 60                           |
| Target Retirement Income | £35,000                      |
| Monthly Expenditure      | £2,660                       |
| Health Status            | Yes                          |
| Smoking Status           | Never                        |
| Education Level          | Professional                 |
| Has Will                 | Yes                          |
| Has LPA                  | Yes                          |

## Address

- The Willows, 15 Camden Road
- Tunbridge Wells, Kent, TN1 2QE

## Domicile

- Country of Birth: South Africa
- UK Arrival Date: 2005-06-01
- Years UK Resident: 21
- Domicile Status: UK domiciled

Spouse

| Field                    | Value                     |
|--------------------------|---------------------------|
| Name                     | Harold Bennett            |
| Date of Birth            | 1953-08-10                |
| Age                      | 72                        |
| Gender                   | Male                      |
| Annual Income            | £0 (retired)              |
| Employment Status        | Retired                   |
| Former Employer          | HMRC                      |
| Occupation               | Retired Civil Servant     |
| Health Status            | Yes (previous conditions) |
| Smoking Status           | Quit long ago             |
| Education Level          | A-Level                   |
| Target Retirement Age    | 65                        |
| Target Retirement Income | £30,000                   |

Family Members

| # | Name           | Relationship | DOB        | Age | Dependent | Notes                                                |
|---|----------------|--------------|------------|-----|-----------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Mark Bennett   | Child        | 1980-03-15 | 45  | No        | Son, married, lives in London with 2 children        |
| 2 | Susan Clarke   | Child        | 1983-07-22 | 42  | No        | Daughter, married, lives in Brighton with 3 children |
| 3 | Emma Bennett   | Grandchild   | 2009-05-10 | 16  | No        | Mark's daughter                                      |
| 4 | Thomas Bennett | Grandchild   | 2012-09-28 | 13  | No        | Mark's son                                           |
| 5 | Lucy Clarke    | Grandchild   | 2014-02-14 | 11  | No        | Susan's daughter                                     |
| 6 | Sophie Clarke  | Grandchild   | 2017-11-30 | 8   | No        | Susan's daughter                                     |
| 7 | William Clarke | Grandchild   | 2020-06-18 | 5   | No        | Susan's son                                          |

Properties

1. The Willows (Main Residence)

| Field   | Value                                          |
|---------|------------------------------------------------|
| Address | 15 Camden Road, Tunbridge Wells, Kent, TN1 2QE |

| Field             | Value                                                   |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Type              | Main Residence                                          |
| Current Value     | £550,000                                                |
| Purchase Price    | £185,000                                                |
| Purchase Date     | 1995-06-01                                              |
| Ownership         | Joint (50%)                                             |
| Primary Residence | Yes                                                     |
| Bedrooms          | 4                                                       |
| Council Tax Band  | F                                                       |
| Notes             | Mortgage paid off since 2010. Family home for 30 years. |

Monthly Costs:

| Cost                | Amount |
|---------------------|--------|
| Council Tax         | £265   |
| Gas                 | £85    |
| Electricity         | £65    |
| Water               | £40    |
| Building Insurance  | £45    |
| Contents Insurance  | £30    |
| Maintenance Reserve | £100   |

## Mortgages

None

## Savings Accounts

1. Joint Current Account

| Field     | Value                                               |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Provider  | Nationwide                                          |
| Type      | Current Account                                     |
| Balance   | £8,500                                              |
| Ownership | Joint                                               |
| Notes     | Main household account for pension income and bills |

2. Patricia's Cash ISA

| Field    | Value      |
|----------|------------|
| Provider | Nationwide |

| Field                      | Value      |
|----------------------------|------------|
| Type                       | Cash ISA   |
| Balance                    | £45,000    |
| Interest Rate              | 4.5%       |
| ISA Subscription This Year | £8,000     |
| Ownership                  | Individual |
| Monthly Contribution       | £500       |

### 3. Harold's Cash ISA

| Field                      | Value    |
|----------------------------|----------|
| Provider                   | NS&I     |
| Type                       | Cash ISA |
| Balance                    | £42,000  |
| Interest Rate              | 4.0%     |
| ISA Subscription This Year | £6,000   |
| Owner                      | Spouse   |
| Monthly Contribution       | £400     |

### 4. Premium Bonds

| Field     | Value                                 |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|
| Provider  | NS&I                                  |
| Type      | Premium Bonds                         |
| Balance   | £50,000                               |
| Ownership | Joint                                 |
| Notes     | Tax-free prize draws, maximum holding |

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## Investment Accounts

### 1. Patricia's Stocks & Shares ISA

| Field               | Value                   |
|---------------------|-------------------------|
| Provider            | AJ Bell                 |
| Type                | ISA                     |
| Current Value       | £65,000                 |
| Annual Contribution | £10,000                 |
| Ownership           | Individual              |
| Platform Fee        | 0.25%                   |
| Risk Profile        | Cautious / Lower Medium |

Holdings:

| Holding                  | Ticker | ISIN         | Type | Units | Cost/Unit | Price/Unit | Value   | Allocation | Fee   |
|--------------------------|--------|--------------|------|-------|-----------|------------|---------|------------|-------|
| Vanguard LifeStrategy 40 | VGLS40 | GB00B3TYHH97 | Fund | 260   | £200.00   | £250.00    | £65,000 | 100%       | 0.22% |

2. Harold's Stocks & Shares ISA

| Field               | Value                   |
|---------------------|-------------------------|
| Provider            | Vanguard                |
| Type                | ISA                     |
| Current Value       | £85,000                 |
| Annual Contribution | £12,000                 |
| Owner               | Spouse                  |
| Platform Fee        | 0.15%                   |
| Risk Profile        | Cautious / Lower Medium |

Holdings:

| Holding                   | Ticker | ISIN         | Type | Units | Cost/Unit | Price/Unit | Value   | Allocation | Fee   |
|---------------------------|--------|--------------|------|-------|-----------|------------|---------|------------|-------|
| Vanguard LifeStrategy 40  | VGLS40 | GB00B3TYHH97 | Fund | 200   | £180.00   | £250.00    | £50,000 | 59%        | 0.22% |
| Vanguard UK Equity Income | VUKE   | IE00B3X1LR22 | Fund | 1,167 | £25.00    | £30.00     | £35,000 | 41%        | 0.22% |

Pensions

DC Pensions

None

DB Pensions

1. NHS Pension Scheme (Patricia)

| Field                 | Value         |
|-----------------------|---------------|
| Type                  | Public Sector |
| Annual Pension        | £18,500       |
| Normal Retirement Age | 60            |
| Inflation Protection  | CPI           |
| Spouse Benefit        | 50%           |
| Years of Service      | 30            |

| Field              | Value                                                 |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Already in Payment | Yes                                                   |
| Notes              | Retired at 60. 30 years service. Index-linked to CPI. |

2. Civil Service Pension (Harold)

| Field                 | Value                                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Type                  | Public Sector                                         |
| Annual Pension        | £22,000                                               |
| Normal Retirement Age | 65                                                    |
| Inflation Protection  | CPI                                                   |
| Spouse Benefit        | 50%                                                   |
| Years of Service      | 35                                                    |
| Already in Payment    | Yes                                                   |
| Owner                 | Spouse                                                |
| Notes                 | Retired at 65. 35 years service. Index-linked to CPI. |

State Pension

Patricia

| Field             | Value                  |
|-------------------|------------------------|
| Weekly Forecast   | £221.20                |
| Annual Forecast   | £11,500                |
| State Pension Age | 66                     |
| Already Receiving | Yes                    |
| Notes             | Full new state pension |

Harold

| Field             | Value                  |
|-------------------|------------------------|
| Weekly Forecast   | £221.20                |
| Annual Forecast   | £11,500                |
| State Pension Age | 66                     |
| Already Receiving | Yes                    |
| Notes             | Full new state pension |

Protection

Life Insurance

None

Critical Illness / Income Protection

None

Liabilities

None

Gifts

| # | Type             | Recipient                 | Amount  | Date       | Notes                             | Status         |
|---|------------------|---------------------------|---------|------------|-----------------------------------|----------------|
| 1 | PET              | Mark Bennett (child)      | £20,000 | 2022-04-15 | House deposit contribution        | Within 7 years |
| 2 | PET              | Susan Clarke (child)      | £20,000 | 2021-06-20 | House deposit contribution        | Within 7 years |
| 3 | Annual Exemption | Patricia to grandchildren | £3,000  | 2024-04-06 | To Emma, Thomas, Lucy Junior ISAs | Within 7 years |
| 4 | Annual Exemption | Harold to grandchildren   | £3,000  | 2024-04-06 | To Sophie, William Junior ISAs    | Within 7 years |
| 5 | Annual Exemption | Patricia to grandchildren | £3,000  | 2025-04-06 | To Emma, Thomas, Lucy Junior ISAs | Within 7 years |
| 6 | Annual Exemption | Harold to grandchildren   | £3,000  | 2025-04-06 | To Sophie, William Junior ISAs    | Within 7 years |

Trusts

None

Business Interests

None

Chattels

| # | Item                 | Value   | Ownership  | Notes                                       |
|---|----------------------|---------|------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Jewellery Collection | £8,000  | Individual | Patricia's, including grandmother's pieces  |
| 2 | Antique Furniture    | £12,000 | Joint      | Georgian sideboard and Victorian dining set |

Expenditure

Total Monthly: £2,660

| Category  | Amount |
|-----------|--------|
| Housing   | £280   |
| Utilities | £250   |

| Category               | Amount |
|------------------------|--------|
| Food & Groceries       | £450   |
| Transport & Fuel       | £200   |
| Insurance              | £180   |
| Entertainment & Dining | £300   |
| Holidays & Travel      | £400   |
| Gifts & Charity        | £350   |
| Healthcare & Medical   | £50    |
| Other                  | £200   |

## IHT Profile

| Field          | Value                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Marital Status | Married                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Available NRB  | £325,000                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Available RNRB | £175,000                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Notes          | On first death, assets transfer to spouse tax-free. On second death, both NRBs and RNRBs available (up to £1M). Combined estate ~£845k so IHT exposure ~£138k on second death. |

## Key Concerns

1. Will our pensions keep up with inflation?
2. How much Inheritance Tax will our children pay?
3. Should we be gifting more now while we can enjoy seeing them use it?
4. What happens if one of us needs care?
5. Are we protected if pension rules change under new government policies?
6. Should we consider equity release or is that a last resort?

## Highlights

### Estate Planning

| Metric                | Value    |
|-----------------------|----------|
| Gross Estate Value    | £845,500 |
| Available NRB         | £650,000 |
| Available RNRB        | £350,000 |
| Current IHT Estimate  | £138,200 |
| Gifts in Last 7 Years | £40,000  |

Risk Profile

- **Patricia:** Lower Medium
- **Harold:** Lower Medium
- **Notes:** Retired couple focused on capital preservation and income generation. Cautious approach with DB pension income security.

Will

Mirror Wills

| Field                      | Value                                |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Has Will (Both)            | Yes                                  |
| Spouse Primary Beneficiary | Yes (100% on first death)            |
| Executor                   | Mark Bennett & Adams & Co Solicitors |
| Last Updated               | 2023-08-15                           |

**Executor Notes:** Mirror wills in place. On first death, everything to surviving spouse. On second death, estate split equally between Mark and Susan. Specific legacies to grandchildren for education.

Bequests (on second death):

| Beneficiary                  | Type            | Amount/% | Priority | Conditions                         |
|------------------------------|-----------------|----------|----------|------------------------------------|
| Mark Bennett                 | Percentage      | 50%      | 2        | On second death                    |
| Susan Clarke                 | Percentage      | 50%      | 2        | On second death                    |
| Grandchildren Education Fund | Specific Amount | £25,000  | 1        | Divided equally when they reach 18 |

Goals

1. Annual Gifting to Grandchildren

| Field                | Value                                                                          |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Type                 | Custom (Gifting Strategy)                                                      |
| Description          | Use both annual exemptions (£6,000 total) to gift to grandchildren Junior ISAs |
| Target               | £6,000                                                                         |
| Current              | £3,000                                                                         |
| Target Date          | 2026-04-05                                                                     |
| Module               | Savings                                                                        |
| Priority             | High                                                                           |
| Monthly Contribution | £500                                                                           |
| Ownership            | Joint                                                                          |

2. Grandchildren Education Trust

| Field | Value |
|-------|-------|
|-------|-------|

| Field                | Value                                                                          |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Type                 | Education                                                                      |
| Description          | Build education fund across 5 grandchildren's Junior ISAs for university costs |
| Target               | £75,000                                                                        |
| Current              | £24,000                                                                        |
| Target Date          | 2035-09-01                                                                     |
| Module               | Investment                                                                     |
| Priority             | Medium                                                                         |
| Monthly Contribution | £300                                                                           |
| Ownership            | Joint                                                                          |

3. Care Fee Reserve

| Field                | Value                                                                                                   |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Type                 | Custom (Care Planning)                                                                                  |
| Description          | Maintain liquid savings for potential care costs without selling home. Target 3 years residential care. |
| Target               | £180,000                                                                                                |
| Current              | £145,500                                                                                                |
| Target Date          | 2030-12-31                                                                                              |
| Module               | Savings                                                                                                 |
| Priority             | Critical                                                                                                |
| Essential            | Yes                                                                                                     |
| Monthly Contribution | £500                                                                                                    |
| Streak               | 60 months                                                                                               |
| Ownership            | Joint                                                                                                   |

4. Inheritance Tax Reduction Target

| Field       | Value                                                                                          |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Type        | Custom (Estate Planning)                                                                       |
| Description | Reduce estate below combined NRB + RNRB threshold (£1M) through strategic gifting over 7 years |
| Target      | £100,000                                                                                       |
| Current     | £46,000                                                                                        |
| Target Date | 2032-04-05                                                                                     |
| Module      | Savings                                                                                        |
| Priority    | High                                                                                           |
| Ownership   | Joint                                                                                          |

5. Annual Holiday Fund

| Field                | Value                                                                                     |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Type                 | Holiday                                                                                   |
| Description          | Annual family gathering holiday - cruise or European trip with children and grandchildren |
| Target               | £8,000                                                                                    |
| Current              | £2,500                                                                                    |
| Target Date          | 2026-08-01                                                                                |
| Module               | Savings                                                                                   |
| Priority             | Low                                                                                       |
| Monthly Contribution | £600                                                                                      |
| Ownership            | Joint                                                                                     |

Life Events

| Event                              | Type             | Amount  | Impact  | Date       | Certainty             |
|------------------------------------|------------------|---------|---------|------------|-----------------------|
| Harold's 70th Birthday Celebration | Large Purchase   | £5,000  | Expense | 2023-08-10 | Confirmed (Completed) |
| Golden Wedding Anniversary Trip    | Large Purchase   | £12,000 | Expense | 2028-06-15 | Likely                |
| Home Care Support                  | Medical Expense  | £20,000 | Expense | 2032-01-01 | Possible              |
| Grandchildren Wedding Gifts        | Gift Given       | £20,000 | Expense | 2030-08-01 | Possible              |
| Replace Car                        | Large Purchase   | £22,000 | Expense | 2027-09-01 | Likely                |
| Kitchen & Bathroom Refresh         | Home Improvement | £25,000 | Expense | 2027-03-01 | Likely                |
| Annual Gift to Children            | Gift Given       | £6,000  | Expense | 2026-12-01 | Confirmed             |

Letter to Loved Ones

Patricia's Letter

Immediate Actions

1. Contact Mark immediately - he is co-executor with Adams & Co
2. Contact Adams & Co Solicitors (01892 523 456)
3. Access joint Nationwide account for immediate expenses
4. Contact AJ Bell about investment accounts
5. Notify NHS Pensions about death (survivor pension applies)
6. Register the death at Tunbridge Wells Register Office
7. Obtain at least 10 death certificates

Key Contacts

| Role              | Name                                 | Contact                                             |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Executor          | Mark Bennett & Adams & Co Solicitors | Mark: 07700 900789 / Adams & Co: 01892 523 456      |
| Solicitor         | Adams & Co Solicitors                | 01892 523 456 / estates@adamsco.co.uk - David Adams |
| Financial Adviser | Self-directed (AJ Bell / Vanguard)   | AJ Bell: 0345 123 4567 / Vanguard: 0800 587 0460    |

Pension Survivor Benefits

- Harold receives 50% of Patricia's NHS pension (£9,250/year)
- Continues for Harold's lifetime, index-linked to CPI

Funeral Wishes

- **Preference:** Cremation
- **Service:** St John's Church, Tunbridge Wells. Reception at home. Traditional Church of England service. Hymns: 'How Great Thou Art', 'Morning Has Broken'. Donations to NHS Charities Together.

Harold's Letter

Immediate Actions

1. Contact Mark immediately - he is co-executor
2. Contact Adams & Co Solicitors (01892 523 456)
3. Access joint Nationwide account for immediate expenses
4. Contact Vanguard about S&S ISA
5. Notify Civil Service Pensions about death

Pension Survivor Benefits

- Patricia receives 50% of Harold's Civil Service pension (£11,000/year)
- Continues for Patricia's lifetime, index-linked to CPI

Funeral Wishes

- **Preference:** Cremation
- **Service:** St John's Church. Simple reception at home. Donations to British Heart Foundation.